Hosting a MeshCore Repeater

For rooftop, tower and grain-leg owners asked to host a small radio repeater · Informational only

MeshCore is a small-radio text mesh growing across Indiana: no cell service, no internet, no monthly bill. Every repeater is owned and run by an individual volunteer, and what the network needs most is **height**. This explains what hosting one usually involves.

What hosting usually involves

- **No cost to you.** Hardware, mounting, installation and upkeep are the operator's. No rent or fees in either direction.
- **Nothing touches your network.** A standalone radio. No connection to your Wi-Fi, IT systems or building wiring.
- **Small, non-penetrating footprint.** A lunchbox-sized box and small antenna, clamped to an existing rail or on a ballasted mount. No roof penetrations without your written OK.
- **Solar and battery by default.** If you'd rather offer an outlet, it draws less than a phone charger. Your call.
- **Easy out.** The equipment stays the operator's. Ask for removal and it should come down promptly at no cost to you.

How it usually works

1. **Talk to the operator.** Ask anything — see the common questions below.
2. **Site visit.** Mounting and power options, your access and safety rules, your questions.
3. **Written agreement.** A short document between you and the operator covering ownership, access, responsibilities and removal.
4. **Install.** Usually about an hour, grounded and secured against wind.
5. **Operator maintains it.** Monitored over the mesh; visits scheduled with you.

Quick facts

Technology	MeshCore, open-source LoRa
Frequency	915 MHz ISM band, license-free
Transmit power	Well under 1 watt
Carries	Short encrypted texts; no voice or video
Interference	Separate band from Wi-Fi, cellular and building systems
Power draw	A few watts at most; solar-capable
Who runs it	An individual hobbyist operator, not a company

Why height matters

Every foot of elevation extends coverage. Rooftops, amateur radio towers, farm grain legs, or anywhere up high with a clear view are ideal: a repeater there can cover a whole town and reach the next one.

Have a site but no operator yet?

List it so a volunteer operator can find it, or ask in the Indiana Mesh community chat.

GitHub: **`github.com/mutiny19/hoop`** · “Offer a site”
Discord: **`discord.gg/2uwyceSF37`**

Still have a question? Ask the operator — they are the ones running the equipment and are best placed to answer. For general background on the mesh, see the MeshCore project's own docs at **docs.meshcore.io** and the live coverage map at **map.okimesh.org**.

Informational only. This is not an offer, a contract or legal advice. Any hosting arrangement is solely between a site owner and an individual operator; this page represents no network, collective or organization.